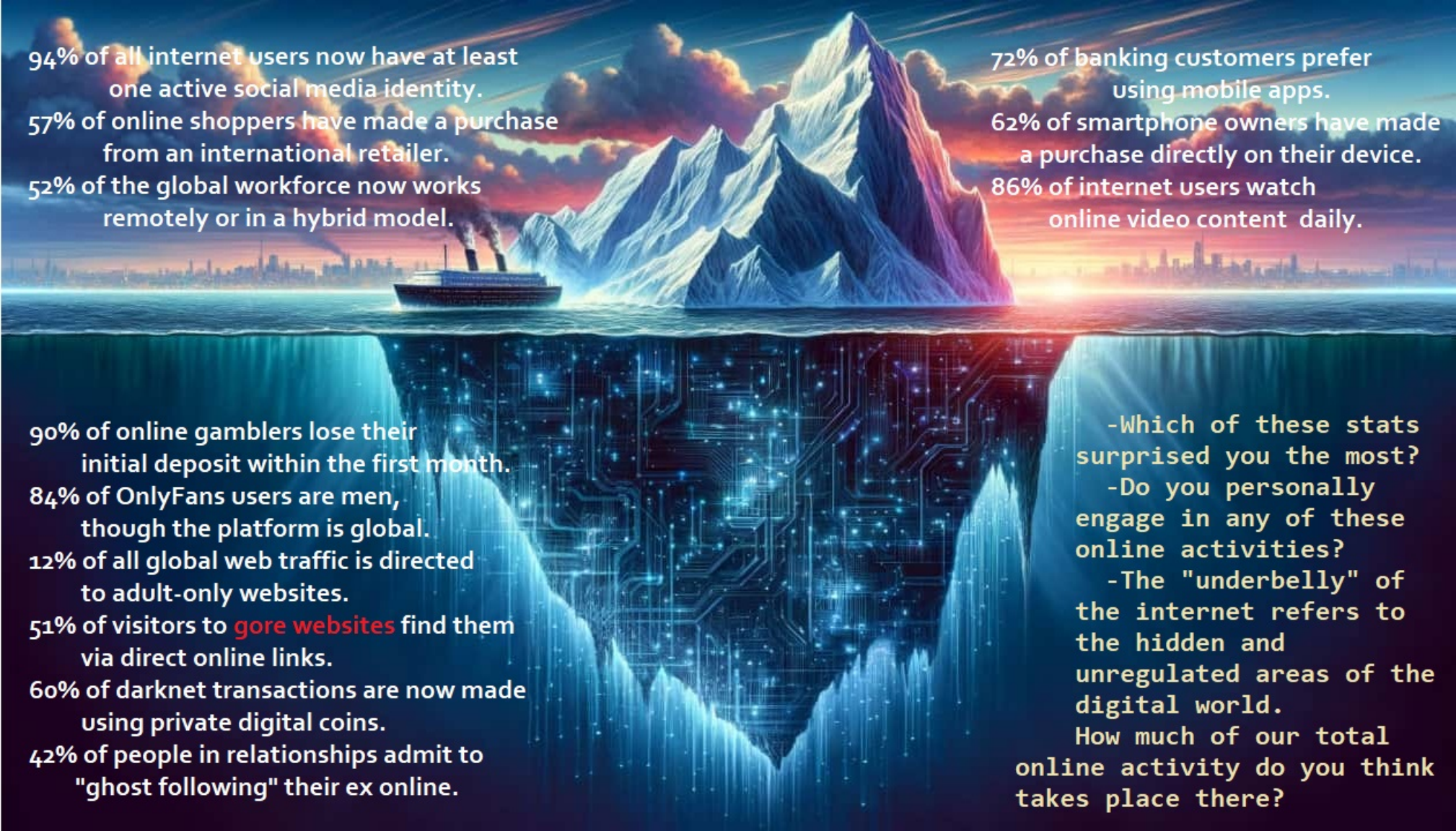


An illustration of an iceberg floating in the ocean. The tip of the iceberg, which is above the water line, is white and jagged, representing the visible part of internet activity. The much larger part of the iceberg is submerged below the water line and is filled with a glowing blue and purple digital circuit pattern, representing the hidden or 'underbelly' of the internet. In the background, a city skyline is visible on the horizon under a sunset sky with orange and blue clouds. A steamship is visible on the water to the left of the iceberg.

94% of all internet users now have at least one active social media identity.
57% of online shoppers have made a purchase from an international retailer.
52% of the global workforce now works remotely or in a hybrid model.

72% of banking customers prefer using mobile apps.
62% of smartphone owners have made a purchase directly on their device.
86% of internet users watch online video content daily.

90% of online gamblers lose their initial deposit within the first month.
84% of OnlyFans users are men, though the platform is global.
12% of all global web traffic is directed to adult-only websites.
51% of visitors to **gore websites** find them via direct online links.
60% of darknet transactions are now made using private digital coins.
42% of people in relationships admit to "ghost following" their ex online.

-Which of these stats surprised you the most?

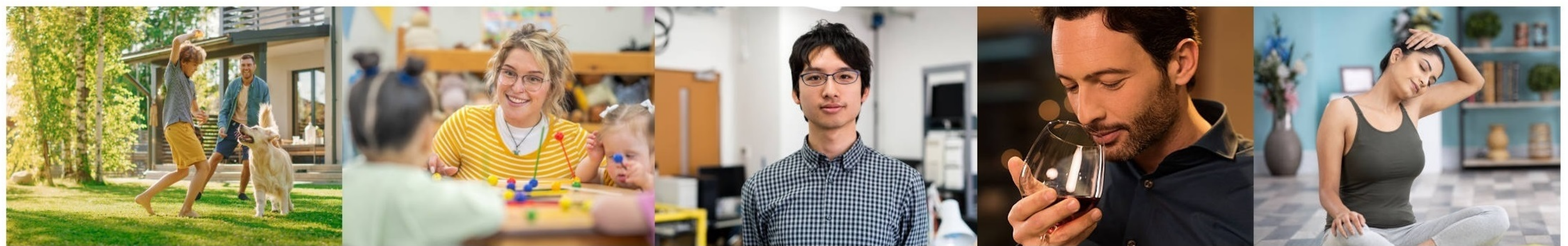
-Do you personally engage in any of these online activities?

-The "underbelly" of the internet refers to the hidden and unregulated areas of the digital world.

How much of our total online activity do you think takes place there?

Read the five short introductions below. These people describe their public lives, hobbies, and values. Then, look at the Secret Labels list. Based only on the intros, try to guess which "hidden" internet activity belongs to which person:

- The Anonymous Online Troll
- The Hentai Enthusiast
- The OnlyFans Model
- The Secret Online Gambler
- The Gore Video Fanatic



"Hey, I'm **Devon**! I'm a typical white-collar clerk working for the government. Most of my day is spent handling paperwork and filing taxes. I lead a very disciplined life and I'm big on following the rules. I'm a family man – two kids, a golden retriever – and I spend my weekends hiking or at the local library. People generally see me as a reliable, stable guy."

"Hi there! I'm **Nora**. I've been a kindergarten teacher for five years now. I love crafting, Pinterest, and baking vegan cookies for my neighbors. My life is basically bright colors and 'Please and Thank You.' I'm all about being a positive role model for the little ones and staying away from anything negative or toxic."

"I'm **Marcus**. I work as an IT consultant, but I'm a bit of a tech geek in my spare time, too – I build my own PCs and I'm really into peaceful gardening. I'm a quiet guy who doesn't like conflict, so I mostly keep to myself. I appreciate the simple, calm things in life and try to stay out of the spotlight."

"Hello, I'm **Arthur**. I've taught Classical Literature at the university level for over twenty years. I appreciate the 'finer things' – classical music, fine wine, and deep philosophical discussions. I have quite traditional values, and I've always preferred the depth of the Great Works over the shallow nature of modern pop culture."

"Namaste, I'm **Maya**! I'm a yoga instructor and wellness coach. My life is dedicated to meditation, spreading kindness, and finding inner peace. I try to stay focused on 'Good Vibes Only' and I work hard to keep my digital presence uplifting and positive for all of my followers."

Reporting Verbs

1. To refuse

2. To profess

3. To acknowledge

4. To concede

5. To insist

6. To deny

7. To proclaim

8. To maintain

9. To admit

10. To reject

11. To claim

Match to the Correct Category

A. Accepting something is true (usually something negative).

B. Saying something is NOT true.

C. Asserting something is true (often when others doubt it).

D. Announcing something publicly (often a belief or a lie).

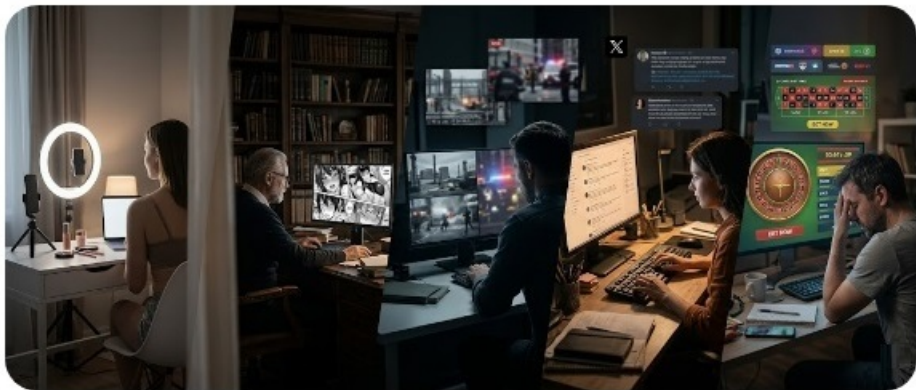
Instructions: List the numbered reporting verbs from the left column into the correct lettered category boxes on the right.

Before listening to the **confessions**, complete the vocabulary task on the left. These reporting verbs are key to understanding the speakers' emotions, so pay close attention.

Listen again if necessary and answer these questions:

1. Whose wife believes a "technical glitch" is responsible for their financial problems?
2. Who uses "freelance editing" as a cover story for their roommate?
3. Whose colleagues believe they are the most patient person in the building?
4. Who skipped a professional dinner to follow a digital "storyline" at home?
5. Whose partner questioned the strange audio coming from their home office?
6. Who feels a specific sense of guilt during their morning meditation?
7. Whose boss thinks they are the most fiscally responsible employee?
8. Who claims to be a pacifist who saves spiders instead of killing them?
9. Whose reputation is built on the works of authors like Dante and Milton?
10. Who mentions using a ring light immediately after grading papers?

- Can a private financial habit be considered a family or even a marriage betrayal?
- Can a teacher's private activities be a legitimate reason for dismissal from their job?
- Can watching gore content be seen as a sign of a mental disorder or a violent personality?
- Can visually stunning, sexualized images be seen as art, or are they strictly pornography?
- Is it ever okay to leave mean comments online or spread hate speech on social media?



1. Digital footprint
2. Digital identity
3. Digital shadow
4. Digital surveillance
5. Digital hygiene
6. Digital detox
7. Digital exile
8. Digital era

Match the collocations with the explanations, then listen to the politician to check your answers.

- A. A period of time when a person chooses to stay away from all electronic devices; it is a break to focus on the "real" world.
- B. A punishment where a person is banned from using the internet or social media; it means being "kicked out" of the digital world.
- C. The act of a government or company watching what people do online; it is used to monitor behavior for safety or control.
- D. The current period of history where technology and the internet are the most important parts of daily life for most people.
- E. The information created about you by others or by systems, often without you knowing; it is the part of your data you cannot see.
- F. The permanent record of everything you do, post, or visit online; it is like a trail of "tracks" that stays behind you forever.
- G. The practice of keeping your online life clean and safe; this includes changing passwords and deleting old accounts or apps.
- H. The way you are represented online, including your accounts and personal data; it is who the internet "thinks" you are.



Many people argue that it is much harder to be a "good person" today in the **digital era** than it was fifty years ago. Most teenagers do not realize that their **digital footprint** can stop them from getting a professional job in the future. It is perfectly healthy to have a **digital identity** that is completely different from the person you are in the real world. We should have the legal right to see and delete our **digital shadow** if it contains information we did not create. Increased **digital surveillance** is a small price to pay if it helps the government catch criminals and dangerous trolls. Parents should be responsible for teaching **digital hygiene** to their children, rather than the government or the schools. A mandatory **digital detox** once a year would improve the mental health and productivity of the modern workforce. The threat of **digital exile** is too cruel because, in modern society, you cannot survive without access to the internet.

